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FundFlow User Guide

Who this is for: members and fund administrators **What it covers:** how money is structured, how it moves for every major feature, and how to operate the member portal and the admin portal day to day.

Use this as the single handbook to share with your fund’s users. Technical repair manuals for accountants remain separate.

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1. Big picture

FundFlow keeps track of two kinds of money for every member:

Balance	Everyday meaning	Used for
Cash	Wallet — money available now	Contributions, loan payments, cash-out to your bank
Fund	Your share of the cooperative pool	Builds equity; used when you borrow

The fund also keeps **master** (pool-wide) cash and fund balances. Those must always equal the **sum of all members’** cash and fund balances.

Three ideas to remember

1. **Ledger vs bank** — Accepting a deposit or cash-out updates the ledger (balances). Matching an imported bank line later only proves the transfer happened; it does **not** move money a second time.

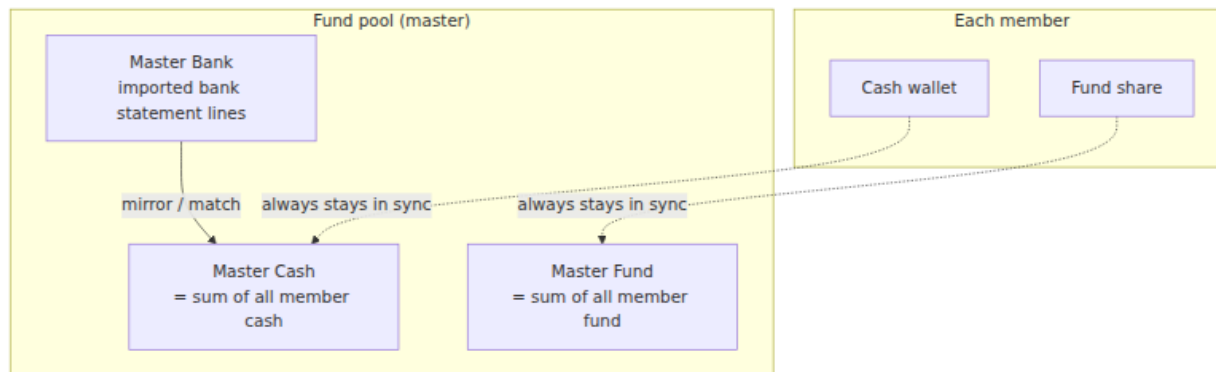


Figure 1: Diagram 1

2. **Cash-in often auto-settles** — When cash increases, the system can immediately collect a due contribution or loan installment.
3. **Loan cash is not a bank payout** — Disbursement credits the member's cash wallet. Sending money to the member's real bank is a separate **cash-out**.

2. Accounting structure

2.1 Chart of accounts (plain language)

Account	Who sees it	Purpose
Member Cash	Member + admin	Spendable balance
Member Fund	Member + admin	Equity in the pool (can go negative while a loan is active)
Member Loan	Member + admin	Tracks principal on an active loan
Master Cash	Admin	Pool cash on hand (= sum of member cash)
Master Fund	Admin	Pool equity (= sum of member fund)
Master Bank	Admin	Control account for imported bank statement lines
Master Fees	Admin	Fee income (late fees, membership / subscription fees)
Master Expense / Invest / Suspense	Admin	Operating expense, investments, and clearing / exceptions

2.2 Mirror rule (why every move has two sides)

When a member's cash or fund changes for a pool event, the matching **master** account changes by the same amount in the same journal.

Example — contribution of 1,000 collected

Step	Account	Effect
1	Member Cash	−1,000
2	Master Cash	−1,000 (mirror)
3	Member Fund	+1,000

Step	Account	Effect
4	Master Fund	+1,000 (mirror)

Cash left the wallet and became fund equity. Pool totals stay consistent.

2.3 Bank clearance is a separate step

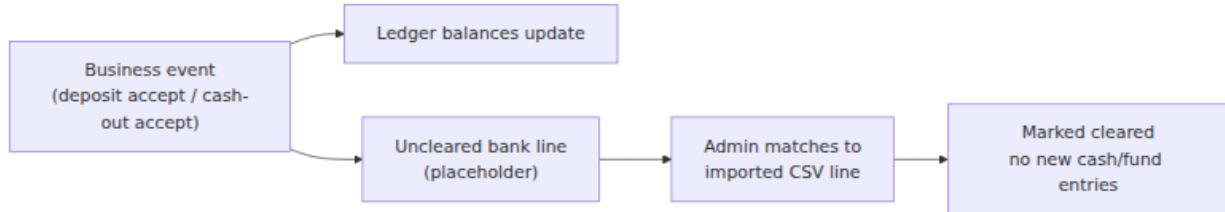


Figure 2: Diagram 2

3. How money flows (all features)

3.1 Deposit (member reports money sent to the fund)

Typical path

1. Member transfers money to the fund's bank account.
2. Member submits a **deposit** in the portal (amount, date, reference / attachment).
3. Admin **accepts** → Member Cash ↑ and Master Cash ↑.
4. Later, admin **clears** / **matches** the uncleared line to the bank CSV.

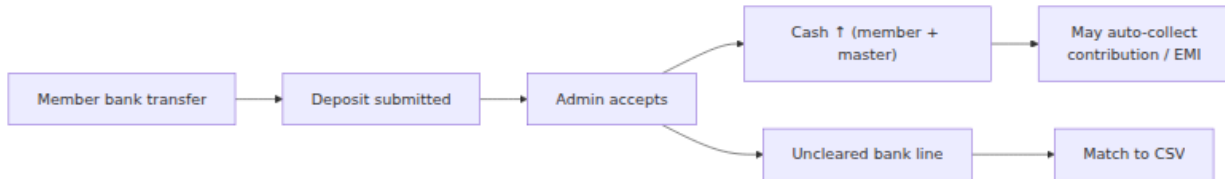


Figure 3: Diagram 3

Example: Nora deposits 2,000. After accept, her cash is 2,000. If she owes a 500 contribution, the system can collect it immediately → cash 1,500, fund +500.

Alternate admin path (bank first): Import CSV → **Mirror to cash** (Master Bank + Master Cash) → **Post to member** (Member Cash). Do **not** also accept a deposit for the same money.

3.2 Monthly contribution

Standing monthly amount is chosen by the member (or set by admin) from electable tiers (defaults **500 to 10,500 in steps of 500**; minimum, step, and maximum are configurable in Settings).

When collected for a cycle:

- Cash ↓ (member + master)
- Fund ↑ (member + master)

Open-cycle amount request: Member can ask to raise **this cycle only** above the standing amount. Admin approval changes the cycle's due amount; standing allocation for future cycles stays the same.

3.3 Late fees and annual / membership fees

Fee	Effect
Contribution or EMI late fee	Cash ↓ (member + master) → Master Fees ↑
Membership application fee (on approval)	Cash credited then fee taken to Master Fees (no bank line)
Annual subscription fee	Cash ↓ → Master Fees ↑

3.4 Cash-out (withdraw to personal bank)

1. Member requests cash-out (only available cash; amounts reserved for due EMI may be blocked).
2. Admin accepts → Cash ↓ (member + master) + uncleared bank debit line.
3. Admin pays the member and **matches** the line to the bank statement.

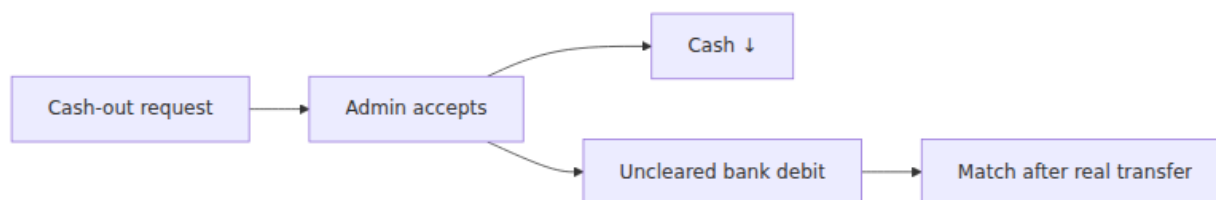


Figure 4: Diagram 4

3.5 Cash transfer (household / peer)

Parent can fund a dependent's cash wallet (or transfer between members when policy allows). Cash moves between members with matching master mirrors so pool totals stay correct.

Example: Parent sends 1,000 to a dependent → parent cash −1,000, dependent cash +1,000 (master cash unchanged overall).

3.6 Loans

Stage	What happens
Apply	Member checks eligibility and submits
Approve	Admin reviews; may use loan queue / tiers
Disburse	Fund equity is used (member portion + pool portion). Full amount is credited to member cash . No automatic bank payout.
Cash-out	Member withdraws cash to their bank when ready
Repay (EMI)	Deposits raise cash; system collects installment: cash ↓, fund ↑, loan balance ↓
Complete	Loan marked completed; guarantor may be released

Repayment idea (simple): You repay the **pool's share** of the loan (plus any settlement rule the fund configured). The part funded from your own fund equity at disbursement is already your equity — it is not collected again as EMI in the same way.

Guarantors: If a borrower defaults, the system may debit the guarantor's fund and/or top up the borrower's cash from the guarantor so installments can be collected. Guarantors can view loans they guarantee in the member portal.

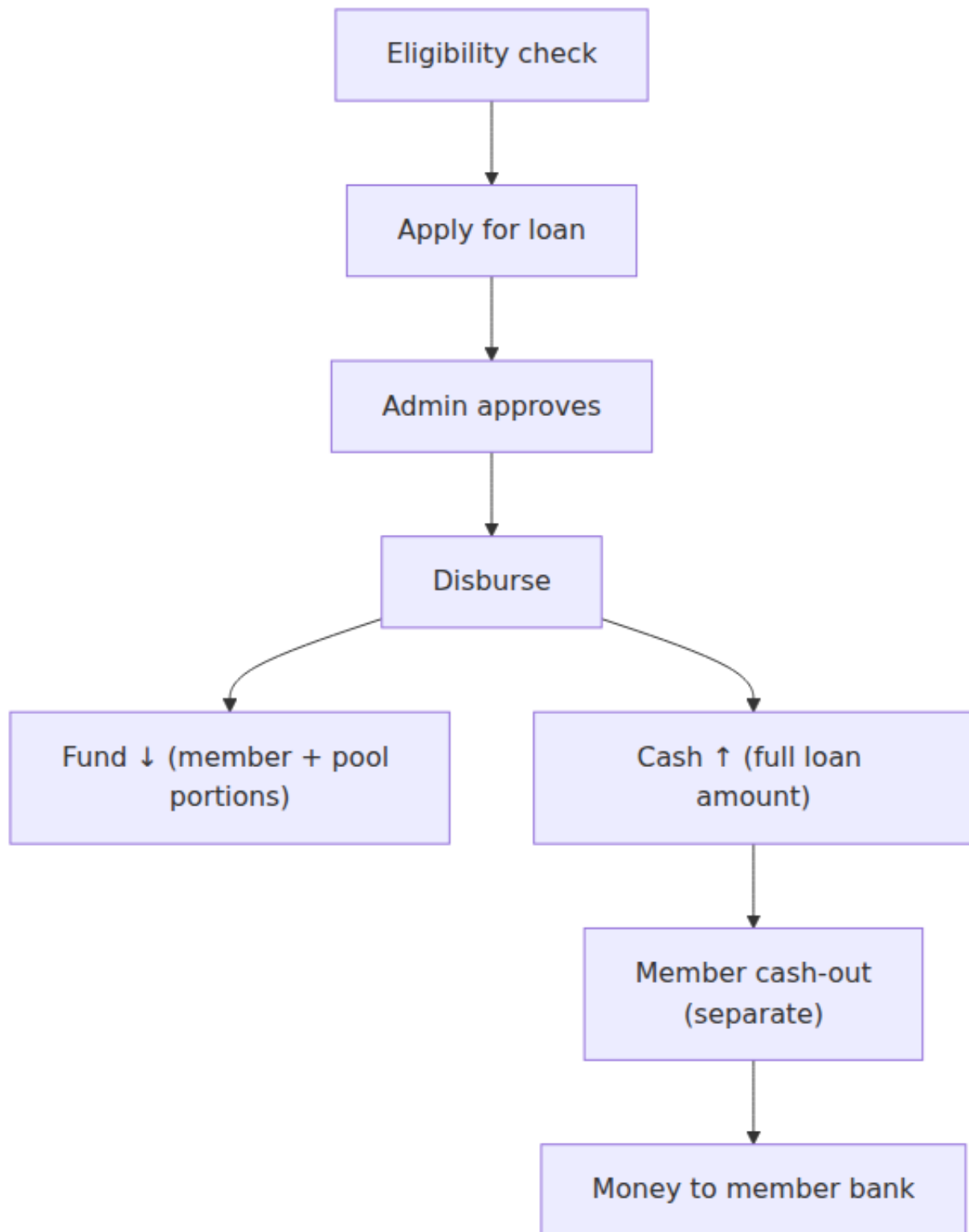


Figure 5: Diagram 5

Admin loan transfer: Admin can reassign a loan to another member (remaining obligation or full unwind + redisburse), depending on the transfer mode.

3.7 Bank import and clearing

Step	Result
Import CSV	Statement lines appear as imported
Mirror to cash	Master Bank and Master Cash move together
Post to member	Member Cash updated (master already mirrored)
Clear / Match	Links ledger intent to a statement line
Post as...	Admin can classify a line (deposit, cash-out, expense, fee, investment, etc.)

SMS bank clearing (if enabled) is an alternate inbound channel that can post to cash similarly.

3.8 Opening balances (new / migrated members)

On membership approval, cut-off cash and fund opening amounts can be posted to member + master cash/fund. These do **not** create bank statement lines.

3.9 Manual adjustments (admin only)

Admins can credit, debit, or refund on accounts when repairing or adjusting. Prefer paired cash/fund tools that keep master and member in sync. Nightly reconciliation flags unpaired drift.

3.10 Reserves (admin only)

Master Fund can move to expense, fees, or investment reserves (and back). Investment returns and check-style disbursements from reserves are admin Finance actions.

3.11 Membership status and leave

Action	Notes
Freeze / unfreeze	Pause membership (requests or admin)
Withdraw / leave	Voluntary exit; settlement may include fund→cash then cash-out
Reinstate / release payout	Admin-controlled return or payout release

4. The monthly collection cycle



Figure 6: Diagram 6

Concept	Meaning
Cycle start day	Configurable (often the 6th). Period runs until the day before the next start.
Open cycle	Current period members are collecting for
Standing allocation	Member's usual monthly contribution amount

Concept	Meaning
Pending / overdue	Not yet fully collected
Arrears	Older unpaid periods (often settled oldest-first when cash arrives)
Exemption / grace	Some members or loan phases skip contribution for a period by policy
Household settlement	Parent cash can cover dependents' contributions and EMIs first, then the parent

Automation (when enabled): init cycle, apply collections, close window, late fees, EMI close, bank auto-match, nightly reconciliation, and status digests run on a schedule under **Audit & System → Automation**.

5. Member portal operation manual

URL: <https://<your-fund-domain>/member>

5.1 Sign in

1. Open the member login page.
2. Enter email and password.
3. Household profiles: sign in with the household email, pick your profile, then confirm with that profile's password or PIN.
4. Separated dependents (own email) sign in directly with their email.

If status is inactive, withdrawn, or otherwise blocked, contact the fund office.

Use the **language switch** for English / Arabic where supported.

5.2 Navigation map

Area	What you do there
Overview	Balances, dues, shortcuts
Cash account	Wallet balance and cash ledger
Fund account	Fund share and fund ledger
Contributions	Cycle dues, status, late fees
Loans	Your loans, installments, settle / pay actions
Apply for loan	Eligibility and application
Guaranteed loans	Loans you guarantee for others
Loan calculator	Estimate amounts before applying
Deposits	Report money you sent to the fund
Cash out	Request withdrawal to your bank
Cash transfer	Move cash to a dependent (or peer if allowed)
Dependents	Household members, allocations, funding
Statements	Monthly statements
Activity / transactions	Recent movements
Requests	Membership, allocation, open-cycle amount, freeze, leave, independence, payout
Messages	Chat with administrators
Settings / profile	Contact details, standing contribution amount, notifications

5.3 Everyday member workflows

Report a deposit

1. Transfer money to the fund bank account (details from admin / public page).
2. **Deposits** → **New** — amount, date, reference or proof.
3. Wait for admin accept. Watch **Cash** rise; dues may auto-collect.

Change standing contribution

1. **Settings** (or contribution settings) — choose an allowed amount (e.g. 500, 1,000, ... up to the fund maximum).
2. Some changes may require admin approval as a **request**, depending on fund policy.

Ask for a larger amount this cycle only

1. From **Contributions** or settings, request an **open-cycle** amount above your standing allocation.
2. Admin approves → this cycle's due rises; future cycles keep your standing amount.

Request a cash-out

1. Ensure cash is available (after dues / EMI holds).
2. **Cash out** → **New** — amount and bank details if required.
3. Wait for admin accept and bank transfer.

Apply for a loan

1. Check eligibility (fund balance, membership length, arrears rules).
2. **Apply for loan** — amount, purpose, guarantors if required.
3. After approval and disbursement, cash rises; submit a **cash-out** when you want the bank transfer.

Manage dependents

1. **Dependents** — request add/remove, set monthly allocation, fund their cash.
2. Parent cash can settle dependents' dues automatically when collections run.

Communicate and track requests

- **Messages** for questions and admin replies.
- **Requests** for formal items (leave fund, freeze, independence, allocation, open-cycle amount).
- **Statements** for monthly PDF / history.

5.4 What members cannot do

- Import or match bank statements
- Touch master accounts or manual ledger repairs
- Disburse loans or accept their own cash-outs
- Change fund-wide settings

6. Admin portal operation manual

URL: <https://<your-fund-domain>/admin> (tenant panel)

6.1 Navigation map

Operations

Area	Purpose
Applications	Approve / reject membership; opening balances and application fees post on approval
Members	Profiles, accounts, status, dependents, fees, manual adjustments
Contributions	Open cycle, generate / collect, arrears, exemptions, late fees
Loans	Approve, reject, disburse, repay, settle, transfer
Loan queue	Priority and projection workbench
Disbursements	Disbursement-focused ops
Delinquency	Arrears, defaults, guarantor actions, digests
Deposits	Accept / reject member fund postings
Cash outs	Accept / reject withdrawals
Cash transfers	Approve member transfers
Requests	Review member requests (allocation, open-cycle, freeze, leave, etc.)
Statements	Generate / view monthly statements
Support	Support tickets

Finance

Area	Purpose
Bank clearing	Import CSV, mirror, post, match / clear, post-as
Bank SMS clearing	SMS-based inbound clearing (if used)
Transactions	Full ledger browser
Member accounts	Per-member cash / fund / loan
Master accounts	Pool accounts and reserve actions
Reconciliation	Exceptions, drift, reports
Reports	Operational / financial reports
Year-end close	Fiscal close readiness

System

Area	Purpose
Settings	Cycle day, contribution tiers, fees, loans, guarantors, bank templates, statements, notifications
Audit & System / Automation	Job schedule, re-runs, logs
Communications	Announcements, templates, messages
Legacy migration	CSV import of historical data

6.2 Daily / weekly admin workflows

A. Membership approval

1. **Applications** → review documents and fees.
2. **Approve** → member + accounts created; opening balances and application fee may post.
3. **Link household parent** if needed; set standing contribution.

B. Deposits and cash-outs

1. **Deposits** → Accept (cash ↑) or Reject.
2. **Cash outs** → Accept when bank transfer is ready (cash ↓ + uncleared line).
3. **Bank clearing** → Match uncleared lines to CSV.

Rule: One economic event, one cash credit/debit. Do not accept a deposit **and** post the same CSV line as a second credit.

C. Bank statement processing

1. Import CSV (correct template).
2. Mirror relevant lines to cash **or** match them to existing uncleared deposit/cash-out lines.
3. Post unmatched inflows to the correct member when using the bank-first path.
4. Ignore noise lines; use **Post as** for expense / fee / investment classifications.

D. Collection cycle

1. Confirm cycle open (automation or manual init).
2. Watch **Contributions** for pending / overdue.
3. Encourage deposits; auto-apply collects when cash arrives (if enabled).
4. After due date: late fees and delinquency review.
5. Clear reconciliation exceptions after close.

E. Loans

1. Review eligibility and guarantors.
2. Approve → Disburse (cash credited to member).
3. Remind member to cash-out if they need a bank transfer.
4. Monitor EMI collection and delinquency; use guarantor tools if policy requires.

F. Reconciliation checklist

Signal	Meaning	Typical action
Master cash / fund pool drift	Master sum of members	Find unpaired posting; rebuild balances if needed
Member cash / fund drift	Stored balance component formula	Inspect ledger; repair with proper reverse tools
Uncleared bank lines	Ledger without bank proof	Import and match
Pending past window	Contribution still open after due	Follow up with member

G. Communications and digests

- Send announcements and direct messages from **Communications**.
- Fund status digests (if enabled) summarize arrears and open items for admins.

6.3 Admin do / don't

Do	Don't
Keep master and member cash/fund paired	Credit master cash alone for a member deposit
Match bank lines after ledger accept	Re-post the same deposit on match
Disburse loan to cash, then cash-out	Assume disbursement already sent money to the member's bank
Use Settings for cycle day, tiers, and fees	Hard-code one-off amounts that break policy
Investigate reconciliation exceptions promptly	Delete raw transactions without reverse tools

7. Settings that affect money

Configure under **Admin** → **Settings** (and Automation for clocks).

Setting area	What it controls
Cycle start day	When each contribution period opens
Standing contribution amounts	Minimum, denomination step, and maximum electable monthly amount
Partial collection	Whether short cash may partially settle open-cycle, arrears, or delinquent members (contributions + EMI)
Late fee tiers	Days and amounts for contribution and EMI late fees
Delinquency thresholds	Missed-cycle rules that flag members / block loans
Annual subscription fee	Yearly fee from cash to Master Fees
Public membership fees	New / resume / renew application fees
Loan rules	Eligibility, max amount, funding split, settlement %, guarantors, grace
Fund / loan tiers	Tier tables for limits and products
Automation schedule	Auto-accept deposits, auto-apply collections, job times
Bank match windows	How far auto/manual matching looks for a pair
Bank / SMS templates	CSV and SMS parsing
Fiscal calendar	Year bounds; closed periods block new posting
Statements & notifications	PDF branding, email / in-app / SMS delivery

8. Quick reference tables

8.1 Event → balances (simplified)

Event	Cash	Fund	Bank line
Accept deposit	↑ member + master	—	Uncleared credit → match later
Collect contribution	↓ member + master	↑ member + master	—
Late fee	↓ member + master	—	Fees income ↑
Disburse loan	↑ member + master	↓ member + master (portions)	—
Accept cash-out	↓ member + master	—	Uncleared debit → match later
Collect EMI	↓ then net zero on cash pair	↑; loan ↓	—
Mirror bank credit	↑ master cash (+ bank)	—	Statement line mirrored
Post mirrored line to member	↑ member cash	—	Posted / cleared

8.2 Who does what

Task	Member	Admin
Submit deposit / cash-out	Yes	Accept / reject
Choose standing contribution	Yes	Can set / approve
Request open-cycle amount	Yes	Approve
Apply for loan	Yes	Approve / disburse

Task	Member	Admin
Import & match bank	No	Yes
Run collection / late fees	No (automatic)	Monitor / re-run jobs
Manual ledger / reserves	No	Yes
Reconciliation	No	Yes

9. Common questions

Why did my cash drop right after a deposit was accepted? The system likely collected a due contribution or loan installment automatically.

Why didn't loan money appear in my personal bank? Disbursement only credits your FundFlow cash wallet. Submit a **cash-out** and wait for admin transfer.

Can I raise only this month's contribution without changing next month? Yes — request an **open-cycle** amount. Your standing monthly allocation stays for future cycles.

Why must admin match bank lines? So the ledger (what the fund believes) stays tied to the real bank statement without double-counting.

What if master cash doesn't equal the sum of member cash? That is a **pool drift** exception. Admins investigate unpaired postings under Reconciliation; accountants may rebuild balances after repair.

Who can change the maximum monthly contribution? Fund admins, under **Settings** → **Collection** → **Standing contribution amounts**.

Related documents

Document	Audience
manual-member-portal.md	Longer member UI walkthrough
manual-administrator.md	Longer admin UI walkthrough
manual-accountant.md	Drift repair and CLI
fund-flow-dynamics.md	Extra technical diagrams
collection_cycle_workflow.md	Deep cycle detail
household-members.md	Parent / dependent login rules

This guide describes the product behaviour as implemented for FundFlow tenants. Exact labels, fees, and automation clocks depend on each fund's Settings.